

Chapter 11

Lay a Foundation Under Your Investments

"An investment in knowledge pays the best interest." –Benjamin Franklin

Developing a philosophy and plan for investing is important for those who *Choose FI*. That's why we've devoted a whole section of the book to smart investing. It's not an accident that the "Invest Better" section is this far back in the book after "Spend Less" and "Earn More." Your savings rate, the difference between what you make and what you spend, is the engine that creates investable wealth, which then creates ongoing income that enables FI. If you have no wealth to grow and maintain, all the investing knowledge in the world won't make a difference.

I didn't understand this when starting on my path to FI. I believed you became wealthy by investing. The limiting belief that investing was a complex process better left to professionals was deeply ingrained. I was convinced there was no way I could do this myself.